

deeper across both listed companies and MNCs,” says Kaustubh Kulkarni, Senior Country Officer-India and Vice Chairman-Asia Pacific, J.P. Morgan.

The focus on mid-caps is relatively new. “Our mid-cap business is expected to grow at over 30% for the next few years, buoyed by the higher growth rate of Indian mid-size companies,” says Kulkarni. In the new economy and energy transition segment, the firms it is looking at include digital consumer businesses, fintech, and payments firms, among others, Kulkarni says.

While deal activity has remained slow in the recent past, J.P. Morgan India has been at the forefront of two of the largest listings on the Indian bourses this year. These include the initial public offering (IPO) of Hyundai Motor India, which was the largest listing in the country, raising \$3.3 billion. It also shepherded the IPO of online food delivery platform Swiggy, which raised \$1.35 billion. And the bank continues to work on several such transactions.

“We were the primary bank for the Swiggy IPO. We were working with Swiggy through various iterations for the last three to four years, and it finally culminated in the IPO,” Kulkarni says, adding that the bank plans to assist in more such IPOs. “If you look at 2025, our team is working on 15 IPOs. And 40% or 50% of them are in effectively new-age or new business companies,” he says.

Hyundai is a classic example, where a large global strategic company which has built a substantial business in India is also looking at capital markets presence, diversifying its shareholder base, connecting more with HNI and retail customers through the stock markets. “What we are saying

is that India is moving reasonably quickly on investors’ radar as an active investment destination—both for strategic and financial investors; it is an important destination for raising capital and an attractive place to build businesses at scale in a reasonably short period of time,” Kulkarni elaborates.

Another significant development is the inclusion of Indian government bonds in the J.P. Morgan Government Bond Index-Emerging Markets this June. Kulkarni underlines that global investors on the credit side are quite keen to get exposure to alternate government securities, and, in that context, India is a very important part of an Emerging Market Index.

Indian bonds have a maximum weight of 10% on the index. “We

error. “In the overall theme, what we see is that India is going to offer a very predictable growth pattern for at least the medium term of five to six years,” he asserts.

Kulkarni is also optimistic about ties between India and the US and believes that the dynamics between the two present a great opportunity for the lender.

The return of Donald Trump as the President of the US could also benefit India. According to a note by J.P. Morgan economists, India will be the least impacted by the Trump administration compared to other Asian countries they studied. “This actually could be a good opportunity for India and Indian domestic companies to continue strengthening their structural alignment, invest-

## TOP 5 LARGE FOREIGN BANKS

| RANK | BANKS               | TOTAL ASSETS<br>(₹ CR) | NET NPA<br>(%) | COST TO INCOME<br>RATIO | ROCE<br>(%) | CAPITAL ADEQUACY<br>(%) |
|------|---------------------|------------------------|----------------|-------------------------|-------------|-------------------------|
| 1    | JPMorgan Chase Bank | 1,26,876               | 0.00%          | 0.18                    | 13.18%      | 21.51%                  |
| 2    | Bank of America     | 1,06,784               | 0.00%          | 0.23                    | 10.21%      | 18.46%                  |
| 3    | HSBC                | 2,96,773               | 0.05%          | 0.37                    | 14.11%      | 15.88%                  |
| 4    | Mizuho Bank         | 36,446                 | 0.00%          | 0.42                    | 5.37%       | 23.37%                  |
| 5    | Sumitomo Mitsui     | 46,245                 | 0.00%          | 0.33                    | 4.94%       | 20.33%                  |

Data for FY24 **Source** BT-KPMG Best Banks and NBFCs Survey 2023-24

have already seen \$8 billion post-close which have come in through the investments and the rest will continue to come,” Kulkarni says, adding that this is a good first step.

Ask Kulkarni about the plans going forward, and he points out that there is intense competition amongst foreign banks, which means there’s very little room for

ments, and manufacturing partnerships,” Kulkarni says.

Ask him if this signals good tidings for the two countries as well as for J.P. Morgan India, and Kulkarni signs off saying in the affirmative. “These are good times.” **BT**

@surabhi\_prasad